

Bangkok Shambhala

User Guide

Your guide to exploring meditation events, community, and resources

Version 1.0 — March 2026

Welcome

Welcome to the Bangkok Shambhala website! We're a non-profit meditation community based in the heart of Bangkok, offering regular meditation sessions, workshops, and retreats for people of all experience levels.

This guide will help you navigate the website and make the most of what our community has to offer.

Website: <https://shambhala-bangkok.org>

1. Finding Events

1.1 Browsing Upcoming Events

1. Visit the website homepage or click **Events** in the navigation menu
2. You'll see a list of **upcoming events** sorted by date
3. Each event card shows:
 - **Title** — name of the session
 - **Date & time** — in Bangkok timezone (GMT+7)
 - **Modality badge** — In-person, Online, or Hybrid
 - **Pricing badge** — Free, By donation, or Paid
 - **Short summary** — what the event is about
4. Click on any event card to see the full details

1.2 Event Detail Page

On the event detail page you'll find:

- **Full description** of the event
- **Date, time, and duration**
- **Location** (with map link for in-person events)
- **Facilitator** information

- **Registration link** (if required)
- **Add to Calendar** button

1.3 Event Types

Type	Description	Typical Schedule
Weekly Meditation	Open sitting meditation practice	Wed 19:00, Sun 10:00
Workshop	Themed session with instruction	Monthly, Saturdays
Retreat	Multi-day intensive practice	Quarterly
Online Session	Virtual meditation via Zoom	Various times
Special Event	Guest teachers, celebrations	As announced

1.4 Past Events

Scroll down on the Events page to find the **Past Events** section. This is useful for:

- Seeing what kinds of events we offer
- Finding recap information or resources from past workshops

2. Adding Events to Your Calendar

2.1 Add a Single Event

On any event detail page:

1. Click the **Add to Calendar** button
2. Choose your calendar:
 - **Google Calendar** — opens Google Calendar with the event pre-filled
 - **Download ICS** — downloads a calendar file you can open in Apple Calendar, Outlook, or any other calendar app

2.2 Subscribe to All Events

Never miss an event by subscribing to our calendar feed:

1. Copy this URL: `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/api/calendar/feed.ics`

2. In your calendar app:

Google Calendar:

- Open Google Calendar → Settings (gear icon)
- Click "Add calendar" → "From URL"
- Paste the URL and click "Add calendar"

Apple Calendar (iPhone/Mac):

- Go to Settings → Calendar → Accounts → Add Account
- Choose "Other" → "Add Subscribed Calendar"
- Paste the URL

Outlook:

- Open Outlook Calendar → Add calendar → Subscribe from web
- Paste the URL

Tip: Calendar subscriptions update automatically, so new events appear without any extra action.

3. Joining the Community

3.1 Community Channels

We use messaging groups to stay connected between events:

Channel	Purpose	How to Join
WhatsApp Group	Main community chat, event updates	Click the WhatsApp button on the Community page
LINE Group	Thai-language community updates	Click the LINE button on the Community page
Facebook	Event photos, articles, public updates	Follow our Facebook page
Instagram	Visual updates, meditation quotes	Follow @shambhalabangkok
Meetup	Event discovery for newcomers	Join our Meetup group

3.2 Joining WhatsApp or LINE

1. Visit <https://shambhala-bangkok.org/community>
2. Click the **Join WhatsApp** or **Join LINE** button
3. You'll be redirected to the group invite link
4. Tap "Join Group" in WhatsApp/LINE

Note: These are community groups — please be respectful and follow our Code of Conduct.

3.3 Newsletter

Stay updated via email:

1. Find the **newsletter signup** in the website footer (bottom of any page)
2. Enter your email address
3. Click **Subscribe**
4. You'll receive:
 - Weekly event reminders
 - Monthly community news
 - Special event announcements

To unsubscribe, click the "Unsubscribe" link at the bottom of any email.

4. Learning About Meditation

4.1 New to Meditation?

Visit the **Learn** page (</learn/meditation>) for:

- What is meditation and why practice it?
- How Shambhala meditation is practiced
- What to expect at your first session
- Weekly schedule for beginners

4.2 Weekly Schedule

Day	Time	Session	Level
Wednesday	19:00 – 20:30	Evening Meditation	All levels
Sunday	10:00 – 11:30	Morning Practice	All levels

First-timers welcome! No experience or special equipment needed. Just come as you are.

4.3 Frequently Asked Questions

Visit the homepage FAQ section or the Learn page for answers to common questions:

- Do I need experience to attend?
 - What should I wear?
 - Do I need to bring anything?
 - Is there a cost?
 - What language are sessions in?
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5. Supporting the Community

5.1 Donations

As a non-profit, we rely on community generosity. Visit the **Donate** page to contribute:

Thai QR / PromptPay:

- Scan the QR code with your Thai banking app
- Instant, free transfer within Thailand

Wise (International Transfer):

- For international supporters
- Low fees via Wise platform

5.2 Where Donations Go

Category	Usage
Venue rental	Monthly rent for our meditation space
Materials	Cushions, books, teaching materials
Events	Workshop supplies, guest teacher travel
Operations	Website hosting, communication tools

5.3 Other Ways to Support

- **Volunteer** — help set up events, welcome newcomers
 - **Share** — tell friends about our events and community
 - **Attend** — regular participation strengthens the community
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6. Finding Our Location

6.1 Address

Bangkok Shambhala Meditation Centre Young Place Building, 3rd Floor Sukhumvit Soi 23
Klongtoey Nua, Wattana Bangkok 10110, Thailand

6.2 Getting Here

BTS Skytrain: Asok station (exit 6), 5-minute walk **MRT Subway:** Sukhumvit station (exit 2),
5-minute walk

6.3 Open in Maps

Visit the **Location** page on the website for:

- Interactive Google Maps embed
- Direct "Open in Google Maps" link
- Address in both English and Thai
- Transit directions

Tip: Save our location in Google Maps for easy navigation on event days.

7. Reading the Blog

7.1 What We Publish

Our blog features:

- **Community news** — updates about our centre and activities
- **Practice tips** — articles on meditation and mindfulness
- **Event recaps** — summaries and reflections from past events
- **Teacher features** — profiles and teachings from our facilitators

7.2 Browsing Posts

1. Click **Blog** in the navigation menu
 2. Browse articles displayed as cards with:
 - Featured image
 - Publication date
 - Title and short excerpt
 3. Click any card to read the full article
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8. About Bangkok Shambhala

8.1 About Pages

Learn more about us through these pages:

Page	Content
About	Overview of our community
About Shambhala	The Shambhala tradition and teachings
Our Vision	Mission and aspirations
Lineage	Teaching lineage and history

8.2 Resources

Visit the **Resources** page for:

- Recommended books on meditation
 - Online practice resources
 - Related organizations and centres
 - Recorded teachings and guided meditations
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9. Navigating the Website

9.1 Desktop Navigation

The main menu appears at the top of every page:

Home · Events · Learn · Community · Blog · About · Donate

9.2 Mobile Navigation

On phones and tablets:

1. Tap the **menu icon** (≡) in the top-right corner
2. The navigation menu slides open
3. Tap any link to navigate
4. Tap the **X** to close the menu

9.3 Footer

At the bottom of every page you'll find:

- Quick links to all main sections
- Social media links
- Newsletter signup
- Legal pages (Privacy, Terms, Code of Conduct)

9.4 Useful Direct URLs

Page	URL
Homepage	/
All Events	/events
Blog	/blog
Community Channels	/community
Donate	/donate
Location & Map	/location
Learn Meditation	/learn/meditation
About	/about
Contact	/contact
Calendar Feed	/api/calendar/feed.ics

10. Accessibility

The website is designed to be accessible to everyone:

- **Keyboard navigation** — all interactive elements can be reached using Tab and Enter
- **Screen reader support** — content is structured with proper headings and labels
- **High contrast** — text meets WCAG AA contrast requirements
- **Reduced motion** — animations respect your system's reduced-motion preference
- **Mobile-friendly** — fully responsive on all screen sizes

If you experience any accessibility issues, please contact us.

11. Privacy

We respect your privacy:

- **No tracking cookies** — we use Plausible Analytics (privacy-first)
- **No personal data collection** — except your email if you subscribe to the newsletter
- **No advertising** — your data is never sold
- **Unsubscribe anytime** — easy one-click unsubscribe from all emails

Read our full Privacy Policy at </privacy> .

12. Contact Us

Channel	Details
Email	bangkok@shambhala.info
WhatsApp	Via Community page
LINE	Via Community page
Facebook	@shambhalabangkok
Instagram	@shambhalabangkok
In person	Young Place Building, Sukhumvit Soi 23, Bangkok

Visit the **Contact** page at </contact> for all contact options.

Quick Start Checklist

New to Bangkok Shambhala? Here's how to get started:

- ☐ Browse upcoming events at </events>
- ☐ Subscribe to the calendar feed (see Section 2.2)
- ☐ Join our WhatsApp or LINE community

- ☐ Sign up for the newsletter
- ☐ Attend your first meditation session
- ☐ Read "What to Expect" on the Learn page
- ☐ Save our location in Google Maps
- ☐ Follow us on social media

Welcome to the community! 🧘

Bangkok Shambhala User Guide v1.0 — March 2026 Visit us at shambhala-bangkok.org